SUPERR SELECTOR SEASON 2 | ROUND 1

Who delivers when it matters?

Methodology and evidence for the pressure performer rankings

The Round 1 brief requests top-ten batter and bowler rankings using IPL and T20I data. The player pool therefore includes eligible role samples from either competition. Their pressure and usual-play evidence is compared within format, then weighted to the player's pressure mix.

BATTER / RANK 1

Shashank Singh

+36.3 per 100

pressure lift vs own usual level

11 pressure matches | 174 deliveries

IPL 174 | T20I 0

95% range +8.8 to +64.1

BOWLER / RANK 1

Shardul Thakur

+36.0 per 100

pressure lift vs own usual level

7 pressure matches | 89 deliveries

IPL 89 | T20I 0

95% range +14.1 to +50.3

What a positive score means

The player produced more context-adjusted runs under pressure than in their ordinary deliveries. For bowlers, runs saved are oriented positive. Rank 1 is the highest estimated pressure lift in that role; batting and bowling scores are not compared with one another.

Data used

Source pack	Ranking scope	After data-quality checks
200,999 deliveries | 883 matches	194,014 IPL/T20I deliveries | 837 matches	77,141 retained; 59,465 scored / 254 matches

The rankings use out-of-time deliveries from 2023-2026; 17,676 retained 2022 warm-up deliveries train the first evaluation year. The pack also contained 6,985 deliveries from other T20 competitions; these were excluded because the brief names IPL and T20I. A T20I-only player may qualify for the challenge ranking if the pressure and usual-play sample rules are met. That is not proof of IPL experience, 2027 auction registration or availability.

Analysis 80843dd8cd70f131 | Data dates 2022-01-22 to 2026-11-01 | 136 IPL/T20I competitions in scope

How pressure and the score are defined

Pressure situations

Situation	Included when
Chase	60 or fewer legal balls remain AND the required rate is at least 8 runs per over.
First innings	30 or fewer legal balls remain AND at least 3 wickets have fallen.

The proposed margin rule estimates how many consecutive dot-ball or boundary shocks can occur before task success drops below 20%. The fallback captures late chases with high run demand and late first innings with few balls and wickets already lost. It found 2 eligible batters and 57 eligible bowlers. Because it could not support both top-ten lists, the documented late-innings fallback above was used for both roles. This is a transparent operational definition, not a validated measure of psychological pressure.

Expected runs and player baseline

A Ridge model trained on earlier IPL/T20I seasons predicts runs for each delivery from the pre-delivery state: score, wickets lost, balls remaining, required rate, innings, phase and IPL-versus-T20I indicator. Each test season uses earlier seasons only. Batting residual = batter runs - expected batter runs. Bowling residual = expected bowler-charged runs - actual charged runs. Positive residual is better for both roles.

Ranked pressure-lift formula

SCORE = 100 x [pressure residual sum - pressure deliveries x usual residual per delivery] / (pressure deliveries + 60)

Usual baseline: the player's average contextual residual on non-pressure deliveries in the same format (IPL or T20I), weighted to match the formats in their pressure sample. Example: pressure residuals total +18 runs over 60 deliveries, while usual output is +0.10 residual runs per delivery. Adjusted total = 18 - (60 x 0.10) = 12; score = 100 x 12 / (60 + 60) = +10 runs per 100 pressure deliveries. The fixed 60-event zero prior shrinks small pressure samples toward zero; it is not 60 observed balls.

Eligibility and uncertainty

Eligibility is role-specific: at least 30 pressure deliveries across 5 matches; 60 non-pressure deliveries across 5 matches overall; and 30 non-pressure deliveries in 3 matches for every format represented in the pressure sample. Ranks sort by score descending, then pressure matches descending, then player ID. The 95% interval uses 400 match-cluster bootstrap replicates and re-estimates the usual baseline in each replicate. It reflects match-to-match uncertainty conditional on the fitted run model; it does not include model-fitting uncertainty.

The score uses runs only. Wickets are reported separately and receive no invented run value. No value is added across the six pressure dimensions.

Top 10 batters under pressure

Ordered by pressure lift versus the player's own usual contextual level. Higher is better; intervals crossing zero indicate uncertainty about the direction of the lift.

Rank / player	Observed role	Lift / 100	P matches	IPL pressure	T20I pressure	95% range
1. Shashank Singh	Death overs	+36.3	11	174	0	+8.8 to +64.1
2. Sanju Samson	Opener, Middle order	+33.5	8	51	8	-0.2 to +67.5
3. Towhid Hridoy	Middle order, Death overs	+31.1	6	0	84	-1.6 to +46.6
4. Rinku Singh	Middle order, Death overs	+29.1	18	149	42	+4.7 to +53.3
5. Liam Livingstone	Middle order, Death overs	+27.0	11	73	52	-0.0 to +49.5
6. Shubman Gill	Opener, Death overs	+26.0	8	59	21	+0.5 to +46.8
7. Abdul Samad	Death overs	+25.0	13	138	0	-9.4 to +60.6
8. Nicholas Pooran	Middle order, Death overs	+23.8	7	69	0	-22.6 to +73.2
9. Rahul Tewatia	Death overs	+22.8	19	112	0	+0.3 to +52.6
10. Suryakumar Yadav	Middle order, Death overs	+19.4	13	99	11	-2.2 to +41.6

Eligibility is based on pressure evidence in the named role and a supported non-pressure baseline. IPL and T20I event counts show where the pressure evidence came from; a zero in one format does not mean zero ability. It means no qualifying pressure deliveries in that format.

Top 10 bowlers under pressure

Ordered by pressure lift versus the player's own usual contextual level. Higher is better; intervals crossing zero indicate uncertainty about the direction of the lift.

Rank / player	Observed role	Lift / 100	P matches	IPL pressure	T20I pressure	95% range
1. Shardul Thakur	Death, Middle overs, Powerplay	+36.0	7	89	0	+14.1 to +50.3
2. Jamie Overton	Death, Middle overs	+33.6	7	38	44	+3.6 to +68.9
3. Andre Russell	Death, Middle overs	+29.8	11	64	13	+1.0 to +55.5
4. Yash Dayal	Death, Middle overs, Powerplay	+28.9	10	76	0	+6.8 to +49.1
5. Jofra Archer	Death, Middle overs, Powerplay	+28.3	14	81	30	+6.2 to +51.6
6. Kyle Jamieson	Death, Middle overs, Powerplay	+27.2	10	21	65	+0.9 to +51.1
7. Karn Sharma	Middle overs	+25.6	7	73	0	-9.3 to +60.5
8. Brijesh Sharma	Not established	+23.7	5	45	0	+9.7 to +41.6
9. Kagiso Rabada	Death, Middle overs, Powerplay	+21.7	15	106	0	+4.1 to +39.9
10. Vaibhav Arora	Death, Powerplay	+21.0	11	99	0	-2.7 to +40.2

Eligibility is based on pressure evidence in the named role and a supported non-pressure baseline. IPL and T20I event counts show where the pressure evidence came from; a zero in one format does not mean zero ability. It means no qualifying pressure deliveries in that format.

Checks, interpretation and limits

Consistency and validation

Player uncertainty resamples whole matches, not individual balls. The rolling task-model check uses 53 later matches in 2026; the linear model Brier score is 0.134 and log loss is 0.410. This checks the match-state task model, not whether player pressure-lift rankings predict future performance. The 2026 data was inspected during this analysis, so it is not a prospectively sealed test.

Data-quality exclusions

Reason	Matches affected
ambiguous extras semantics / penalty timing	475
revised length or target timing unknown	34
abandoned / tied / eliminator	30
incomplete or inconsistent regulation innings	24
missing regulation innings	22
nonterminal chase	17
winner reconciliation failed	7
super over	4
untyped extras	2
over has more than six inferred legal deliveries	1

Exclusion reason counts can overlap. Ambiguous extras are the largest source of excluded IPL/T20I matches and may affect which matches are represented.

What these lists do and do not establish

The rankings describe contextual run contribution relative to each player's usual level in supplied IPL/T20I data. They are not overall talent grades, win-probability predictions, or proof of mental toughness. Venue, opponent, exact batting position, opponent quality and hierarchical season effects are not fully controlled. IPL/T20I cross-format transfer is not established. T20I-only players remain eligible under the brief when they meet these statistical sample rules; they are not presented as auction-available players. Shaheen Afridi has 127 T20I pressure deliveries and 0 IPL pressure deliveries; the revised combined list places him at rank 25, outside the top ten. This is challenge evidence, not IPL auction eligibility.

The supplied pack does not verify IPL 2027 auction registration, player availability, retention, price, purse or Rajasthan Royals' final squad gaps. The report therefore presents evidence for the requested player rankings, not a claim that every ranked player can be purchased or should be selected. RR incumbent comparisons use IPL deliveries only and do not establish a 2027 roster need. The Unstop dropdown options were not available for a direct name-to-option check; confirm the final selections match the displayed names.

Reproduce from the supplied data with analysis/audit.py, analysis/pipeline.py and analysis/report.py. Raw source deliveries remain local; only eligible-player aggregates are included in this report.